

Course response summary

Raters	Students FFO
Responded	5
Invited	9
Response Ratio	55.56%

Response distribution by question

Organization of the course, Conviction Integrity (Hollway/Bluestine/Lowens)

"5" is the highest ranking and "1" is the lowest ranking.

Organization of the course, Conviction Integrity (Hollway/Bluestine/Lowens)				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	4.80
3	0	0.00%		
4	1	20.00%		
5	4	80.00%		

Workload:

1 – too light, 3 – appropriate, 5 – too heavy

Workload:				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	1	20.00%	Mean	2.80
3	4	80.00%		
4	0	0.00%		
5	0	0.00%		

Satisfaction with course materials

"5" is the highest ranking and "1" is the lowest ranking.

Satisfaction with course materials				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	4.60
3	0	0.00%		
4	2	40.00%		
5	3	60.00%		

Clarity and effectiveness of presentations

"5" is the highest ranking and "1" is the lowest ranking.

Clarity and effectiveness of presentations				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	5.00
3	0	0.00%		
4	0	0.00%		
5	5	100.00%		

Instructor's knowledge of the subject matter and identification of underlying principles and issues

"5" is the highest ranking and "1" is the lowest ranking.

Instructor's knowledge of the subject matter and identification of underlying principles and issues				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	5.00
3	0	0.00%		
4	0	0.00%		
5	5	100.00%		

Would you recommend that other students take this course?

1 - Would not recommend, 3 - Would recommend, 5 - Highly recommend

Would you recommend that other students take this course?				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	4.80
3	0	0.00%		
4	1	20.00%		
5	4	80.00%		

Overall effectiveness of instructor – Ethan Lowens

"5" is the highest ranking and "1" is the lowest ranking.

Overall effectiveness of instructor – Ethan Lowens				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	4.80
3	0	0.00%		
4	1	20.00%		
5	4	80.00%		

Overall effectiveness of the course

"5" is the highest ranking and "1" is the lowest ranking.

Overall effectiveness of the course				
Options	Count	Percentage	Statistics	Value
1	0	0.00%	Response Count	5
2	0	0.00%	Mean	4.60
3	0	0.00%		
4	2	40.00%		
5	3	60.00%		

Please note the approximate percentage of classes that you attended.

Mean	Median	Standard Deviation
97.33	99.75	4.62

Please note the approximate percentage of classes for which you had read the assigned materials in advance.

Mean	Median	Standard Deviation
100.00	100.00	0.00

Comment responses**Is there any special preparation or background necessary to take this course?**

Comments
Basic knowledge of criminal procedure is recommended.
None
None, it is an excellent introductory course for these topics while also remaining engaging for those with a background in the topic.
Con criminal pro or crim pro would be helpful

Comment on the instructor's (Ethan Lowens) stimulation of interest in the subject matter and independent thought.

Comments
Prof. Lowens was highly knowledgeable of the course materials and encouraged students to pursue their interests
I always liked how, whether it was just the professors presenting or one of the guest speakers, Professor Lowens always had a really good question or comment to add on to what was just said that made me think more about the subject matter we were learning that week.
Ethan has done an incredible job with the course content. His clear passion for criminology translates well to his teaching and he does an effective job of managing classroom discussion and pulling in students based on their particular interest. His style is particularly effective for the small group setting for this class.
Prof. Lowens was a great professor. He was really thoughtful and listened to our feedback and questions and pushed us to develop our ideas.

Comment on the instructor (Ethan Lowens) with respect to attitude toward students and accessibility outside of class.

Comments
Prof. Lowens created a welcoming and engaging classroom environment. He was consistently respectful, approachable, and readily available to support students both during and outside of class hours.
Professor Lowens treats every student with respect, whether they ask a question or make their own comment to contribute to class discussion. I never needed to access him outside of class, but I know he had meetings outside of class with other students regarding their papers, so I know he is accessible.
Ethan is always quick to respond when reached out to outside of class and regularly tracks questions or points raised by students to circle back on at a later point, highlighting his focus on fostering the individual student's growth.
I found Professor Lowens way more accessible and respectful than the average professor!

Comment on the strengths and weaknesses of the course. How could it be improved?

Comments
The course does an excellent job of presenting a systems-based approach to criminal law. The guest speakers were great, and both they and the course effectively highlighted some of the current challenges. However, there could have been more emphasis on exploring potential solutions, which is an important component of the systems approach. I also think the material covered in the first three weeks could have been condensed into two. Additionally, while the discussion board posts were thoughtful, I think the requirement to comment on others' posts should be reassessed, since it did not consistently lead to meaningful discussions.
Strengths: Guest speakers, very discussion-based, strong professors w/ knowledge, good pacing, engaging presentations
Weaknesses: discussion board – perhaps make it so that students read others' in advance and not respond – I feel like students can probably more effectively respond to points in a discussion setting than on a discussion board – would also allow for more participation in class that way
The class was very strong and did an excellent job of fostering a discussion space. Discussion Boards vastly improved after a mid-semester check-in (changed to focus more on opinion of students rather than recap of the readings).
Strengths: I found that I disagreed with some of the guest speakers, which was a welcome surprise. There was definitely diversity of thought between them. Although I know the professors are friends with many of the guest speakers, I felt hesitant to disagree with them (maybe this could be solicited after they leave?) The Canvas and materials were extremely organized. The readings were interesting and not dry. The final project was structured to welcome creativity and personal interest. The professors were very welcoming and kind.
Weaknesses: It felt like some of the guest speakers were going for shock value or a true crime angle. I find that this is a frequent occurrence in all my classes that discuss sex crimes, where the crime is explained in excruciating detail. I do not know the pedagogical or psychological basis for why this occurs when discussing sex crimes, but it is not an issue constrained to this class. It wasn't horribly offensive to me or anything like that, but it is notable. I actually think this class would be improved if it were larger, around 20 students. I think we would get a more interesting discussion. Discussion stalled on days folks were absent, and it was 4–6 of us.
I really enjoyed this class, and I learned a lot. I liked the weekly themes, really found the diversity of readings interesting, and found all of the presentations to be very informative/enjoyable in the way they came across. I think that my main 'weakness' would be the discussion posts. I think it makes sense to have posts asking for our thoughts/critiques/questions based on the readings, but I think requiring comments on others' posts didn't prove to be super fruitful. Beyond the final project ideas thread, which I thought other people's comments on my own post were helpful, I feel like facilitating debate and conversation in class would be better than requiring replies on the posts. Everyone basically just agreed with one another. Otherwise, I really liked this course! Thank you all for the time and effort you put in. I really appreciated all of the speakers you brought in as well.

Other comments.

Comments
Perhaps add a topic of jury errors – I realize this subject is a challenging one, but since juries play such a pivotal role in the criminal process, I think it would be really interesting to explore that topic as well.
It was a great class and I really liked the chemistry the professors had when they taught.

Each course at Penn Law has stated learning outcomes. To review the learning outcomes for this course, please refer to the Course Finder (goat.law.upenn.edu/cf/coursefinder). Please assess how this course contributed to your achievement of its stated learning outcomes:

Comments
This course was able to contribute toward and help me succeed in achieving my learning outcomes. The presentations were solid and the professor's knowledge assisted there. The readings, though sometimes long, gave a baseline knowledge to assist before class
Achieved learning outcomes.

Mean responses by student's class/degree

Question	Grad	JD26	JD27	Overall
Organization of the course, Conviction Integrity (Hollway/Bluestine/Lowens)	4.00	5.00	5.00	4.80
Workload	3.00	2.50	3.00	2.80
Satisfaction with course materials	4.00	4.50	5.00	4.60
Clarity and effectiveness of presentations	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.00
Instructor's knowledge of the subject matter and identification of underlying principles and issues	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.00
Would you recommend that other students take this course?	5.00	4.50	5.00	4.80
Overall effectiveness of instructor – Ethan Lowens	5.00	5.00	4.50	4.80
Overall effectiveness of the course	4.00	4.50	5.00	4.60

Category Relative Statistics - Seminar

Question	Scores for this course			Category scores (weighted by students) (2026A)			Category scores (weighted by students) (2026B)	
	Mean	Standard Deviation	Median	Mean	Standard Deviation	Median	Mean	Median
Organization of the course, Conviction Integrity (Hollway/Bluestine/Lowens)	4.80	0.45	5.00	4.42	0.86	5.00	4.54	
Workload	2.80	0.45	3.00	3.42	0.78	3.00	3.39	
Satisfaction with course materials	4.60	0.55	5.00	4.33	0.89	5.00	4.48	
Clarity and effectiveness of presentations	5.00	0.00	5.00	4.31	0.96	5.00	4.51	
Instructor's knowledge of the subject matter and identification of underlying principles and issues	5.00	0.00	5.00	4.82	0.53	5.00	4.86	
Would you recommend that other students take this course?	4.80	0.45	5.00	4.40	0.93	5.00	4.55	
Overall effectiveness of instructor – Ethan Lowens	4.80	0.45	5.00	4.53	0.82	5.00	4.66	
Overall effectiveness of the course	4.60	0.55	5.00	4.42	0.85	5.00	4.56	